Cape Cod National Seashore

Evaluation for National Park Status

Deloitte First Year Case Competition

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Jefferson Strategy Group

Recommendation

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Cape Cod maximizes national economic impact while serving one of the country's densest population corridors.

Elevate Cape Cod National Seashore to National Park status.

We evaluated five East Coast candidates using four factors: economic impact, demand and access, national significance, and visitor experience. Cape Cod emerges as the top choice based on current performance and future scalability.

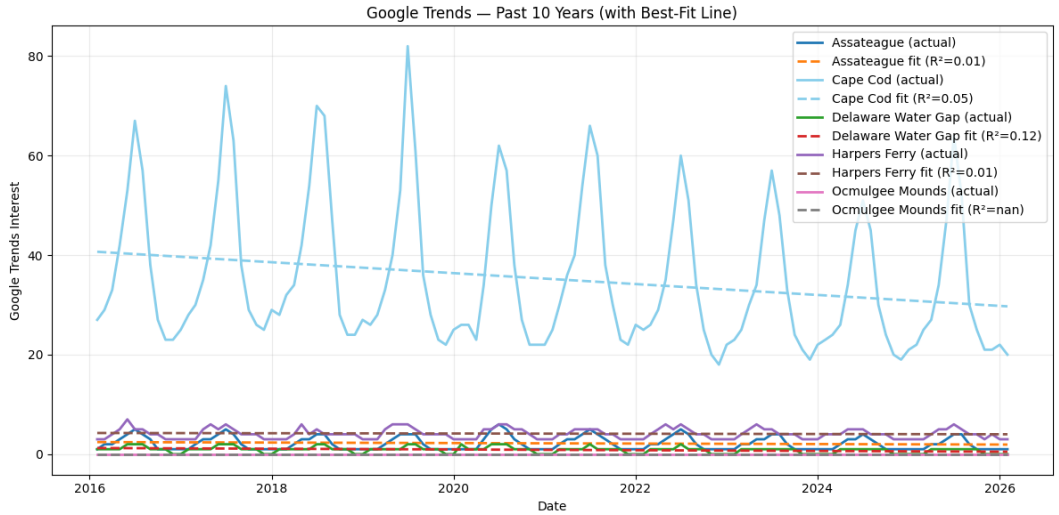
Factor Considerations	
Economic Impact	▪ Revenue & Spending Metrics ▪ Job Creation & Wage Growth ▪ Economic Multipliers
Demand and Access	▪ Capacity (Parking, Lodging, Max) ▪ Accessibility & Transit Scores ▪ Growth Trends (5yr)
National Significance	▪ Feature Diversity & Scale ▪ Seasonality & Year-Round Viability ▪ Regional vs. Non-Local Appeal
Experience and Activities	▪ Unique Activities & Duration ▪ Seasonal Visits Distribution ▪ Safety & Reliability Scores

Cape Cod's Impact Today

- **Overall:** Highest spending per visit + highest output per acre
- **Environmental:** Protect climate-vulnerable Atlantic coastline while scaling proven tourism engine

Park	Visits per Acre	Spending per Visit	Output per Acre ($)
Assateague Island NS	55.252	$52.63	$3,251.09
Cape Cod NS	**87.707**	**$156.46**	**$17,306.76**
Delaware Water Gap NRA	59.377	$40.25	$3,065.95
Harpers Ferry NHP	133.128	$59.82	$11,785.87
Ocmulgee Mounds NHP	41.204	$70.36	$3,515.39

Popularity



Cape Cod's Economic Impact at a National Level

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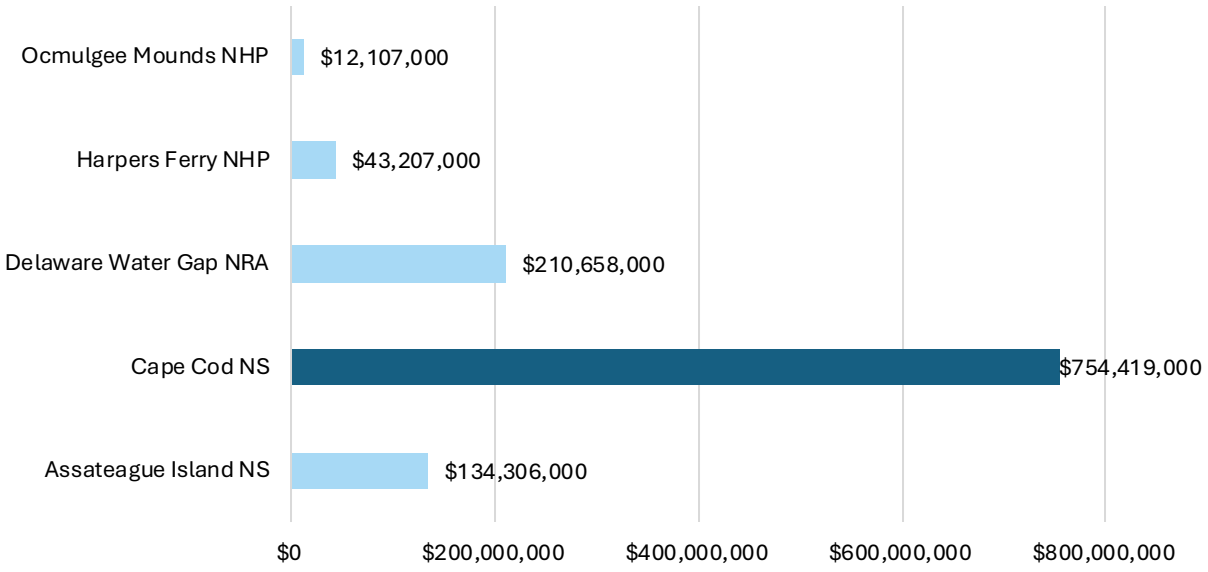
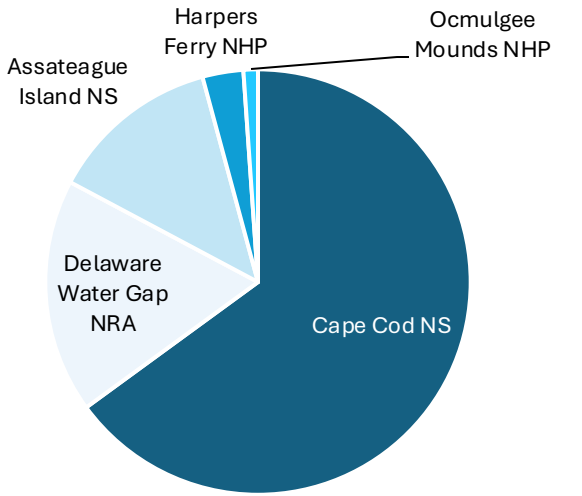
Cape Cod's economic output and visitor spending already operate at full National Park scale.

Economic Output: Cape Cod vs. East Coast Candidates



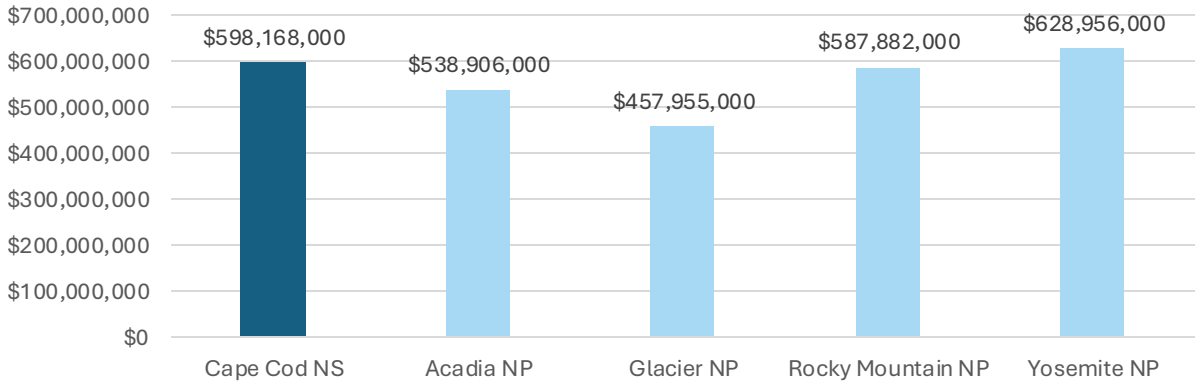
- Cape Cod generates $5754M in economic output, 3.5x the next East Coast Candidate.
- Cape Cod supports 5,385 jobs as of 2024, more than every other East Coast Candidate combined.

Annual Visitor Spending Distribution



Annual Visitor Spending: Cape Cod vs. Leading National Parks

- The annual visitor spending ($598M) rivals leading/iconic National Parks such as Glacier NP and Acadia NP
- Unlike developing sites that rely on projected growth, Cape Cod already operates at national visibility and capacity.



Cape Cod Converts Demand Into Local Jobs and Community Impact

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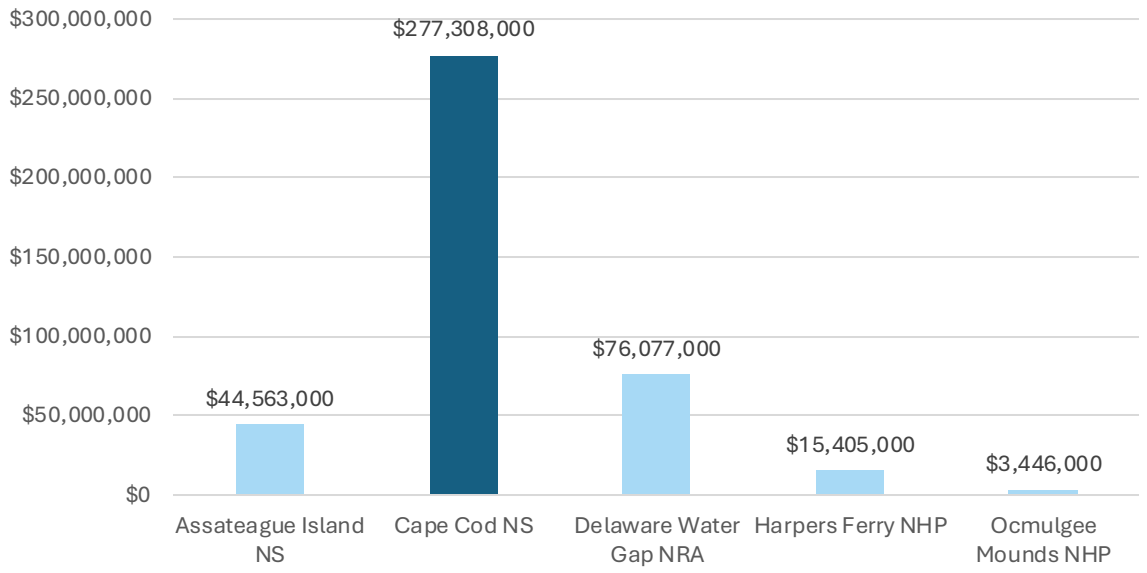
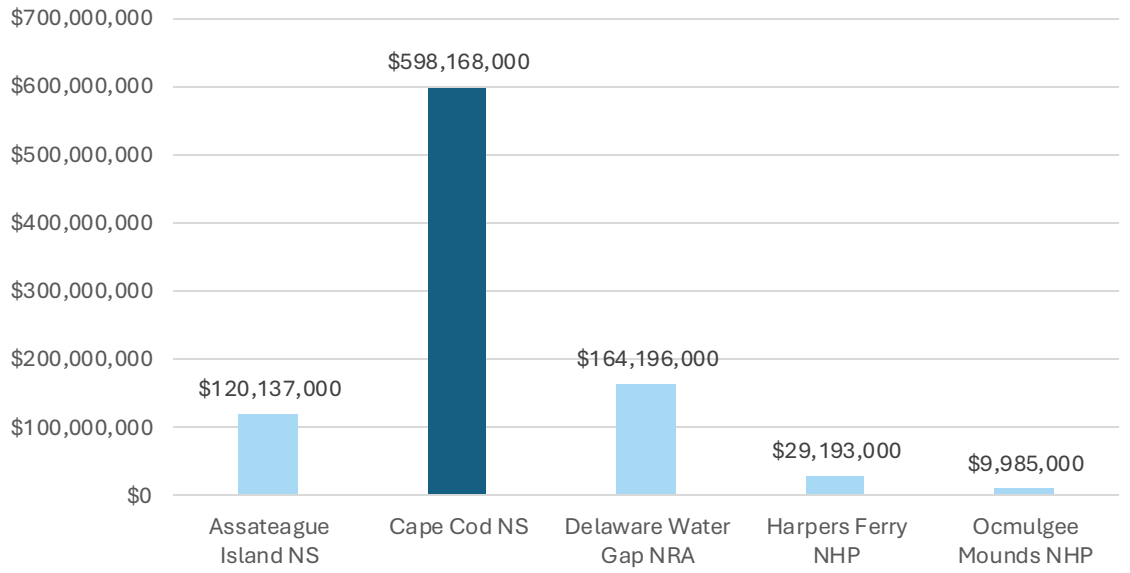
Strong visitation directly translates into the largest employment and labor income impact among East Coast candidates.

Labor Income by Park (5 East Coast Candidates)



Total Visitor Spending by Park (5 East Coast Candidates)



What the Data Shows:

1) **Cape Cod generates $277M in labor income, more than 3x next candidate.**

2) **Supports 5,385 local jobs, largest employment base among East Coast sites.**

3) **Visitor spending of $598M directly circulates into local wages and small businesses.**

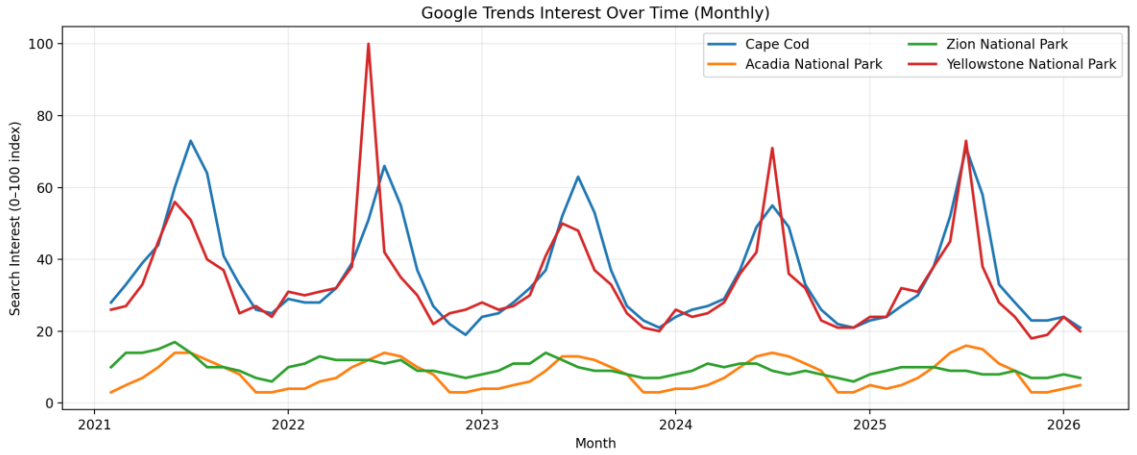
Data Notes (2024):

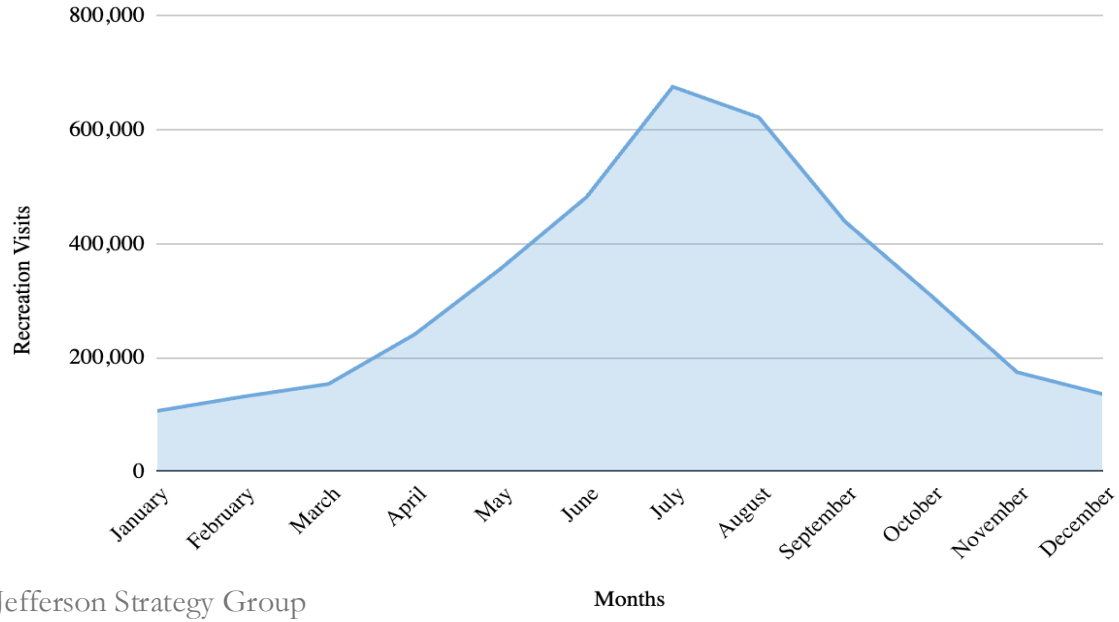
- 2024 National Park Service economic impact data
- Annual visitor spending, labor income, and jobs supported
- Direct + indirect economic effects included

Sustained Demand & Regional Access Advantage

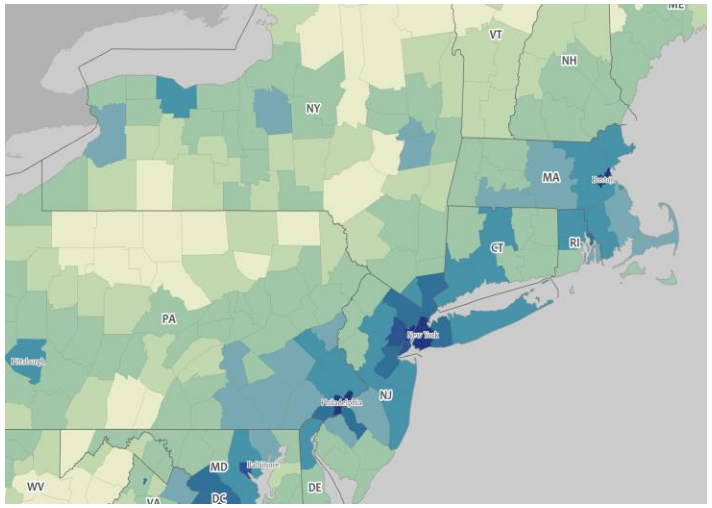
High search demand + dense population access = predictable visitation scale.

Cape Cod: Seasonal Visitation Trends





Dense Northeast Access



Regional Population Concentration (Northeast)

- High concentration of interest across MA, NY, NJ, & PA.
- Within driving distance of 50M+ residents.
- Proximity reduces travel friction vs Western parks.

Key Takeaways

Sustained Search Demand:

- Cape Cod consistently matches or exceeds major parks like Yellowstone.

Real Visitation Conversion:

- Peak summer visitation exceeds ~650,000 monthly visits.
- Shoulder seasons remain strong (May–June, Sept).
- Clear seasonal predictability supports infrastructure planning

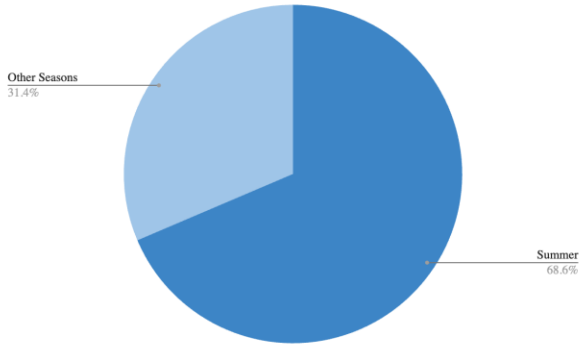
Infrastructure Capacity

Cape Cod already handles high-volume seasonal demand without federal designation.

The Opportunity

- **Already Operating at NP Scale:**
  Infrastructure, staffing, and lodging capacity support high-volume visitation today.
- **Minimal Incremental Investment Required:**
  Federal land, NPS oversight, and operational systems are already in place.
- **Serves as Designation Upgrade, Not a Structural Overhaul:**
  Elevation strengthens preservation and national branding without major capital expansion.
- **Streamlined Implementation Path:**
  Existing National Seashore management simplifies congressional approval and transition.

Cape Cod: Year-Round Population vs. Sumer Surge



1 Operations

- Rangers and management systems already in place.
- Seasonal staffing is routine during peak months.
- Operation backbone for large volume tourists exists.
- Enforcement and Resource Protection are active.

2 Access

- Easy highway access from Boston corridor.
- Regional and International airports support arrival.
- Ferries and rail options already serve the Cape and surrounding areas.
- Public transportation from major cities exists, often at discounted rates for residents.

3 Ecosystem

- Overnight lodging capacity already exists across Cape towns.
- Restaurants and local businesses are built for and already cater to visitors/tourists.
- Local emergency response scaled for seasonal population surges.
- Predictable demand cycles support resource planning.

Predictive Model Analysis: Lodging Revenue Outlook

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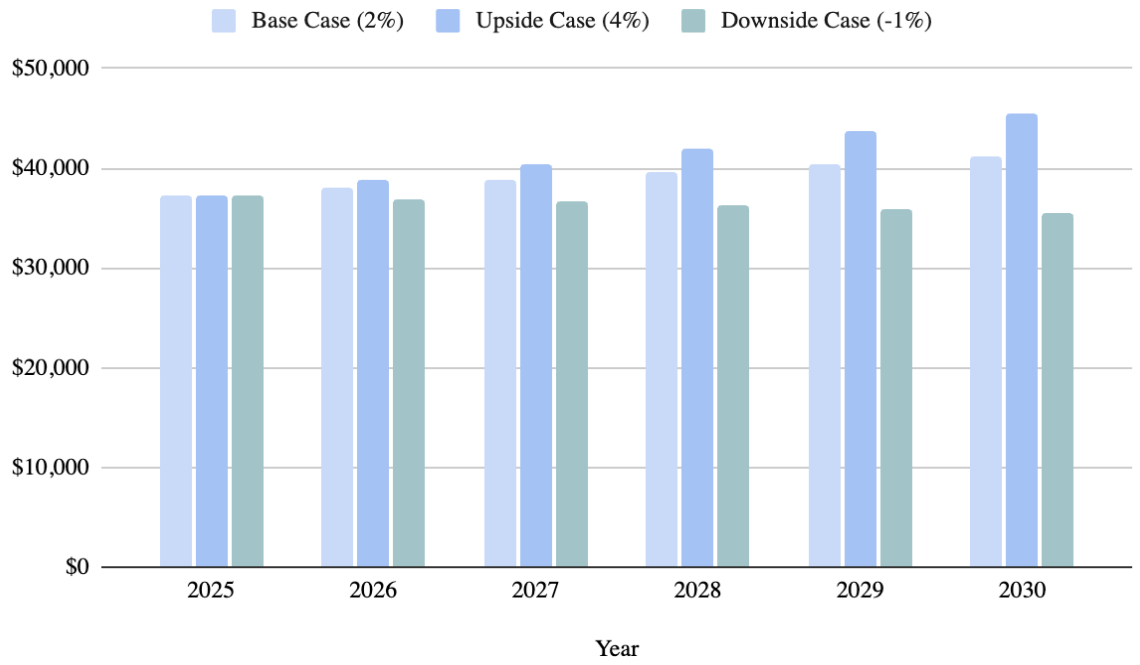
Historical room revenue is stable; scenarios show how it could shift through 2030.

Annual Revenue per Room: 2018-2025 Historic

Annual Revenue per Room: 2026–2030 Scenario Outlook



Using 2025 as a baseline, we modeled three forward scenarios to capture pricing and demand uncertainty. Even under conservative assumptions, revenue per room remains stable, while moderate growth scenarios suggest continued pricing strength through 2030.

Key Insight:

- Lodging economics are durable even under conservative assumptions.
- Room revenue has stabilized post-COVID, with upside potential through 2030.

Quantitative Evaluation Model (LightGBM and XGBoost)

Predictive metrics normalized to 0–100 for objective comparison, and equal-weighted core metrics combined with strategic bonus factors.

Model Structure

CORE METRICS (Base Score – 25% each)

- Visits
- Spending
- Jobs
- Economic Output

+

Bonus Adjustments

- Accessibility
- Year-Round Stability
- Feature Diversity
- Visitor Efficiency
- Season Balance

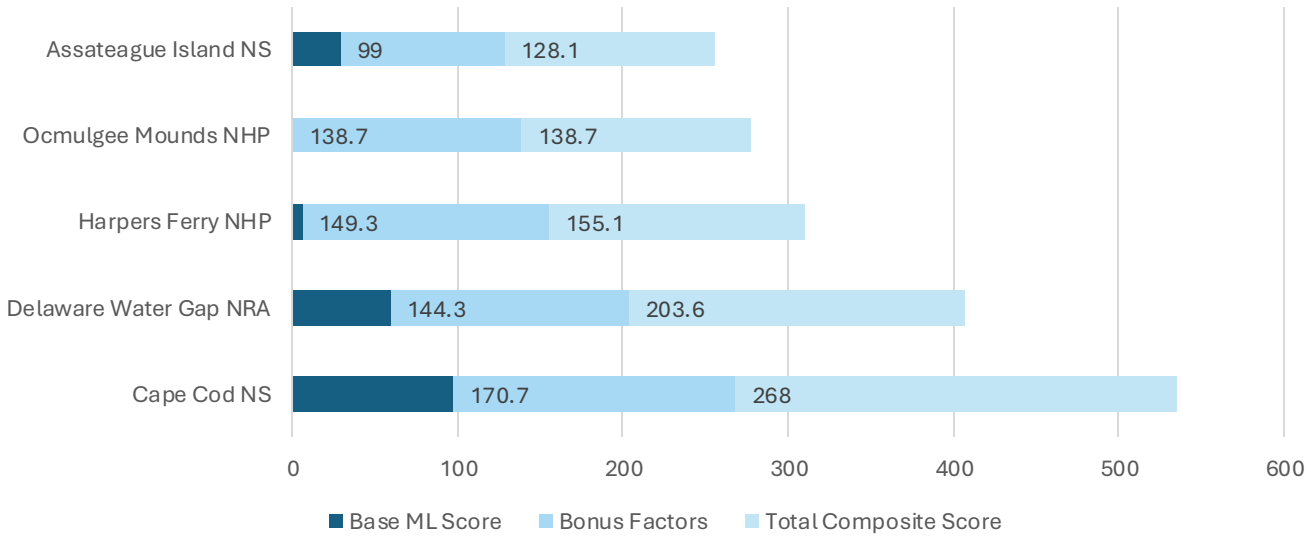
= Total Score

Overall Composite Score by Candidate

Cape Cod leads in all four core economic metrics and remains competitive across strategic bonus factors, producing the highest overall composite score.

Park	Composite Score
Cape Cod NS	136.7
Delaware Water Gap NRA	103.6
Assateague Island NS	66.2
Harpers Ferry NHP	55.3
Ocmulgee Mounds NHP	38.9

Evaluation Model Results Core Metrics + Bonus Factors



Model Validation & Performance Analysis

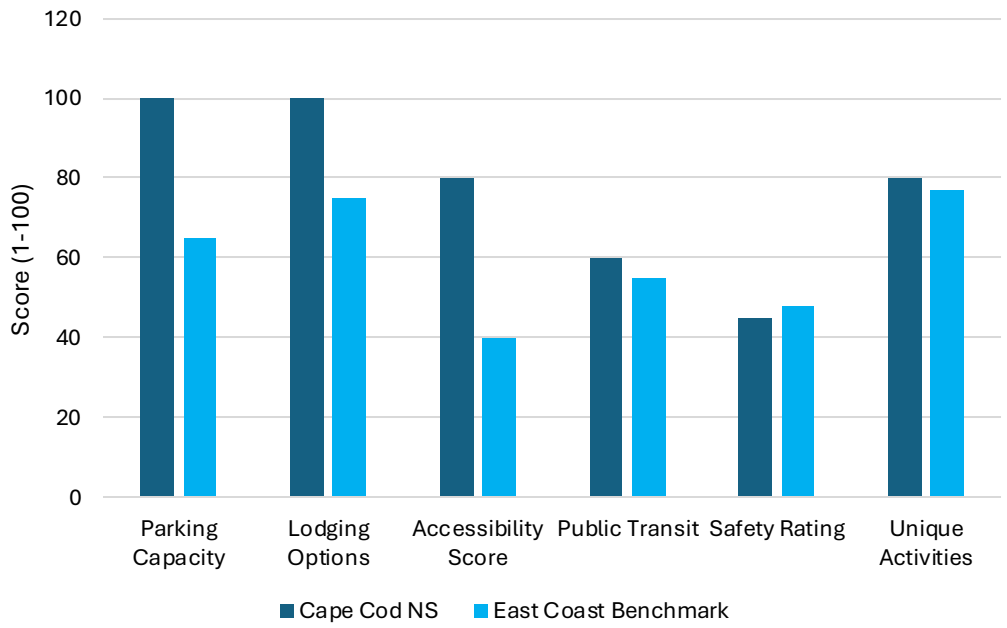
High predictive accuracy and infrastructure-driven bonus modeling confirm Cape Cod's operational advantage.

Model Performance Metrics

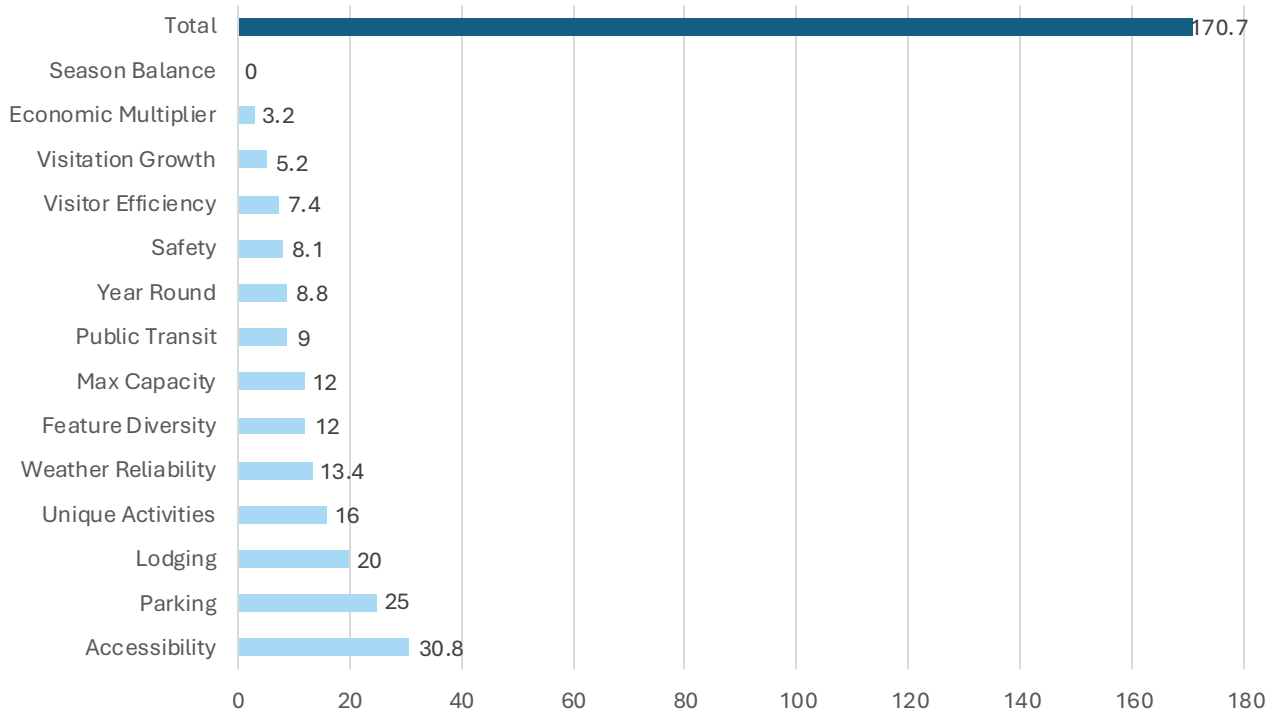
Metric	R^2 Score
Total Recreation Visits	0.947
Economic Output ($)	0.981
Jobs	0.975
Total Visitor Spending ($)	0.970

All models demonstrate strong predictive performance ($R^2 \geq 0.94$).

Overall Infrastructure Metrics



Cape Cod Score Breakdown



Data Overview:

- High R^2 value confirms strong predictive reliability across metrics.
- Bonus factors are infrastructure-based and transparently weighted.
- Cape Cod's lead is consistent across both core metrics and infrastructure drivers.

Guiding Principles

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Our evaluations alignment with the guiding principles.

Visitation & Tourism

- Evaluated multi-year search demand and seasonal visitation trends
- Assessed peak capacity and shoulder-season stability
- Analyzed proximity to major population centers
- Considered long-term demand sustainability without overexpansion

Outstanding National Importance

- Examined ecological uniqueness of coastal barrier systems
- Assessed regional representation of National Parks in the Northeast
- Considered geographic equity relative to other major metro regions

Strategic and Economic Contribution

- Measured visitor spending and tourism output
- Evaluated annual labor income
- Analyzed seasonal job creation and local business dependence

Size, Character, and Coherence

- Assessed recreational diversity (beach, wildlife, trails, maritime history)
- Considered carrying capacity and infrastructure readiness
- Reviewed protected land continuity and management structure

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